



Serkan Sulun, PhD

Machine learning scientist

sulun.org

name [at] surname [dot] org



PUBLICATIONS

- Sulun, S., & Viana, P.** (2026). Lightweight Speech Emotion Recognition with Disjoint Modality Fusion, INTERSPEECH 2026 Demo Session. (*accepted*)
- Sulun, S., Viana, P., & Davies, M. E. P.** (2026). Video Soundtrack Generation by Aligning Emotions and Temporal Boundaries. IEEE Transactions on Multimedia, 1-10. [DOI](#) | [arXiv](#) | [code](#)
- Sulun, S.** (2025). Video-based Music Generation, PhD Thesis. [arXiv](#) | [code](#)
- Sulun, S., Viana, P., & Davies, M. E. P.** (2024). VEMOCLAP - A video emotion classification web application. 2024 IEEE International Symposium on Multimedia (ISM), 137–140. [DOI](#) | [arXiv](#) | [demo](#)
- Sulun, S., Viana, P., & Davies, M. E. P.** (2024). Movie trailer genre classification using multimodal pretrained features. Expert Systems with Applications, 258, 125209. [DOI](#) | [arXiv](#) | [code](#)
- Sulun, S., Oliveira, P., & Viana, P.** (2023). Emotion4MIDI: A Lyrics-based Emotion-Labeled Symbolic Music Dataset. EPIA 2023. Lecture Notes in Computer Science, vol 14116. Springer. [DOI](#) | [arXiv](#) | [code](#)
- Sulun, S., Davies, M. E. P., & Viana, P.** (2022). Symbolic Music Generation Conditioned on Continuous-Valued Emotions. IEEE Access, 10, 44617–44626. [DOI](#) | [arXiv](#) | [code](#)
- Sulun, S., & Tekalp, A. M.** (2021). Can learned frame prediction compete with block motion compensation for video coding? Signal, Image and Video Processing, 15(2), 401–410. [DOI](#) | [arXiv](#) | [code](#)
- Sulun, S., & Davies, M. E. P.** (2020). On filter generalization for music bandwidth extension using deep neural networks. IEEE Journal of Selected Topics in Signal Processing, 15(1), 132–142. [DOI](#) | [arXiv](#) | [code](#)
- Sulun, S.** (2018). Deep Learned Frame Prediction for Video Compression, Master's Thesis. [arXiv](#) | [code](#)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Computer Vision Center, Postdoctoral researcher	May 2026 – Present Barcelona, Spain
INESC TEC, Researcher - Automatic video-based symbolic music generation - Finetuning vision language models for industrial safety	Mar. 2019 – Mar. 2026 Porto, Portugal
University of Porto, Lecturer Lecturer for the course Programming with Python	Sep. 2023 – Present Porto, Portugal
Catolica Porto Business School, Lecturer Lecturer for the course Python for Business Analytics	Mar. 2024 – Present Porto, Portugal
Koc University, Research assistant Video compression and frame prediction using deep neural networks	Sep. 2016 – Nov. 2018 Istanbul, Turkey
Koc University, Teaching assistant Preparing and leading laboratory sessions for the course, Programming with MATLAB	Sep. 2016 – Nov. 2018 Istanbul, Turkey
Champalimaud Centre for the Unknown, Intern - Processing neural signals and videos obtained by rat experiments - Designing the controller board. Article acknowledgment: DOI	Jul. 2013 – Oct. 2013 Lisbon, Portugal
Sabancı University Peer lecturer on freshman mathematics, physics, chemistry, and biology	Feb. 2010 – Jun. 2014 Istanbul, Turkey

EDUCATION

University of Porto

PhD, Electrical and Computer Engineering

Porto, Portugal

Koc University

MS, Electrical and Electronics Engineering (GPA: 3.81/4, converted to 19/20)

Istanbul, Turkey

Sabanci University

BS, Electronics Engineering (GPA: 3.86/4, converted to 20/20)

Istanbul, Turkey

MANAGEMENT AND LEADERSHIP

Principal Investigator: INESC TEC Seed project: Video and MIDI processing using deep neural networks.

Supervisor: Master's thesis: Emotion classification of MIDI lyrics using transformers

Supervisor: Bachelor's project: Speech emotion classification

Coordinator: Lab sessions and 5 assistants in the course, Introduction to MATLAB

SKILLS

Deep learning: Pytorch, Tensorflow, generative AI, transformers, adversarial learning, convolutional neural networks, vision language models, LoRA finetuning, cloud platforms (AWS, GCP, Azure), Slurm

Programming: Python, MATLAB, C++, Julia

Signal processing: MIDI, audio, image, video, natural language processing; video compression; computer vision

Miscellaneous: Machine learning, remote development, Git, LaTeX, Ubuntu, Bash

Music: Drumming, Cubase, Protools, Audacity, MIDI

INVITED TALKS

Introduction to deep learning, *Polytechnic Institute of Porto, Portugal*

Deep learning for music generation, *University of Porto, Portugal*

Deep learning for music information retrieval, *University of Porto, Portugal*

INTERVIEWS

SIC Noticias: Portugal vai receber Turquia

[Website](#) | [YouTube](#)

Observador: Generating music from videos

[Portuguese original](#) | [English translation](#)

Olhar No Progresso: Deep learning, multimedia, and music

[Website](#) | [YouTube](#)

LANGUAGES

English (C2), Portuguese (B1), Spanish (A1), Turkish (native)

ACTIVITIES

Finished in 04:20:05, in the 42 km. Porto Marathon

Drummer, in Santa Cecilia Music School rock band

Parachuting, in Turkish Aeronautical Association with 5-day training camp and 400 m. solo jump

Volunteer, Telfs Youth Center Austria (Erasmus+) and World Wide Opportunities on Organic Farms (WWOOF)